three minutes each and the narration that we give it makes it interesting.'

Further, the BJP's digital strategy is predicated on training its cadres on how to use digital tools for mobilisation. 'Essentially the bedrock of what we did,' says Malviya, 'is really to train our cadres right down to the booth on how to use technology, how to use WhatsApp and how to get information. So, if they said whatever Modiji's government is doing doesn't feature in the newspapers, we said why do you need to read the newspaper? Go to the Narendra Modi app. All this information is there in its sections. Go to the BJP on Twitter and its Facebook page. They have all the information. So, they knew where to get the information from. And then you go and create such a massive network and also sensitise them to the fact that they can use this information effectively. You do that [at] every level. I've spent the best part of my last four-five years training people in my party in terms of how to look at the Narendra Modi app, how to look at Twitter, Facebook to use it very routinely for political communication.'

'The content we put on these platforms is not very different,' he says. 'How we treat it is different. For Instagram, the content we put is more yuppie and cool. Twitter is more political. Facebook is more sedate yet impactful. We do things differently on different platforms, but essentially the message is the same.' The big difference here is that the BJP sees its digital strategy as a core strategic force multiplier for its organic offline ground game. The digital is intrinsic to the strategy and intertwined with the offline. For the Congress, its digital strategy has been an adjunct.'

In contrast to the NaMo app, the Congress's Shakti platform, which reportedly registered 60–80 lakh users, was created as an internal feedback tool for the party leadership to reach out to grassroots workers, and is said to have informed party decision on issues like Rafale and the 'chowkidar chor hai' campaign. Shakti started as a data-collection project that linked party workers' voter IDs to their mobile numbers through a simple SMS. It was meant to enable direct outreach between the top leadership and booth-level workers. However, after the Congress's electoral defeat, it was engulfed in allegations of large-scale 'bonus registrations', 'fake